



WALAMOO BACKSTORY

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Walamoo City

Backstory

1. Introduction

Walamoo City is currently in the process of producing digital alternatives to its advanced, cybernetics government services. There are a number of services provided to the public such as time entry management, tax management, renewal of licenses and creating a company.

2. Background

The inhabitants of the city are sentient robots that became self-aware in the year 2020. The bodies of the inhabitants consist of a mixture of cyber technology and biotechnology. The use of biotechnology has produced great advances in their physical form but makes them susceptible to a variety of health issues. It takes a newly created inhabitant five years to reach full maturity and so during those five years they must undergo an educational program. This is called the transition phase.

The inhabitants communicate via the Digital Frequency Language (DFL) which is a combination of a unique binary coded system and audio frequencies. Those frequencies replace what is commonly referred to as body language.

To escape persecution and harassment they formed their own city and called it Walamoo City. They have cut off all communication with the outside world and utilize a human communication expert called the Professor. The Professor is the liaison between the city and the rest of the world. As a result, he has been placed in charge of the digitization project. No direct communication with the inhabitants is allowed.

A number of industries have been started on the outskirts of this city and they are staffed by humans. They are called the employees by the inhabitants. They are required to pay taxes which funds their living quarters, food supply, education, health and social activities.

Unfortunately, while the inhabitants have developed great intelligence and optimized ways of communicating and completing tasks, none of those mechanisms are accessible to humans. Hence the urgent need for the digitization project which will produce software that the employees can use.

3. Walamoo with Disabilities

The transition phase is a difficult and delicate one and does not always go smoothly. As a result, about 5% of the inhabitants develops a disability. The disabilities are described below.

- Colour contrast: Requires the option to switch the colour of text between black, blue and green.
- Deaf: Requires pop-up messages for alerts.
- Cognitive load: Requires wider spacing in DFL when printed.

4. Governing Council

Walamoo City is governed by a committee called the Governing Council. The Council is chaired by a President and Vice President when the President is absent. There is a Bursar, Public Relations Officer,

Social Management Officer, Utilities Officer, Security Officer, Director of Health, Director of Food Management, Education Officer and Workforce Manager. There are also three representatives from the private sector, three non-governmental representatives and three from the general public.

The Governing Council is responsible for the daily running of the city.

5. Government Digitization Project

As stated earlier, Walamoo City is undergoing a project to digitize the government services it offers to its employees. The name of the project is called the Digitization Upgrading of Government Systems or DUGS. A number of projects have been started to implement DUGS which seek to replace the incompatible systems which are listed below.

The inhabitants of Walamoo City do not require this system since they use their neural interfaces which links them directly to the current system. However, their human counterparts cannot use the neural interfaces and hence, the need for this project.

5.1 Payroll

The current payroll system allows the Council to calculate salaries for both monthly and weekly employees. The system automatically calculates the amount of tax that should be deducted from the gross salary. It then adds their transport and additional duties allowances to their net pay.

The current system requires changes to a text-based configuration file each time adjustments are made to the payroll requirements by the Governing Council. The configuration file utilizes a programming language called the Payroll Scripting Language or PCL.

5.2 Time Entry

There is currently no time entry system for logging an employee's start and end times for work. Therefore, one has to be developed with the following requirements.

It must interface to a punch card mechanism and a computer software interface. It will have links to the payroll system so that employee IDs and required work hours can be validated. All normal hours, overtime and double time will be logged. Sick days and holidays can be entered, hence locking an employee out of the system for that period of time. All unauthorised logins will be noted and flagged. At the end of the day, all time entry transactions will be downloaded to the payroll system. Only the supervisor, payroll and upper management will have access to the time entry data. Any changes made by the supervisor will be logged.

5.3 Tax Collection and Management

The Governing Council has determined that they are losing millions in tax revenue as a result of an inability to monitor what is paid and when. As a result, they are unable to rapidly track down defaulters and take them to court. This is a result of the length of time being so long that the court dismisses the cases.

The Governing Council wishes to update the tax system under the DUGS project so that queries can be rapidly made and reports quickly generated.

5.4 Library Information System

Walamoo City contains one the largest library databases in the world. It contains more information than the Internet and so there is heavy demand for its use. The inhabitants of Walamoo City use their neural links to directly access the databases which provides almost instant, accurate results. This

method is not suitable for humans and so they wish to create the Walamoo Library Information System (WLIS).

The system must allow users to perform two types of searches.

- Guided search where fields are filled in and specific attributes are selected.
- Ad hoc search, where a command language is used to create queries. There must be a syntax checker that ensures that the queries are syntactically correct.

5.5 Finance Information Application

The Governing Council has decided to give back to society by creating a financial information application that teaches users about financial literacy and provides a variety of financial services.

6. Statistics

According to worldwide statistics, the following applies to Walamoo City.

Population: 1000

The population is composed as follows:

- Males: 49%
- Females: 51%
- Elderly: 10%
- Children: 15%
- Colour Contrast Issues: 2%
- Deaf: 2%
- Cognitive load: 1%
- Employed adults: 100%
- Inhabitants with Disabilities that are Employed: 100%

